management that takes care of this job with the help of supervisors and dietitians.

2.2.1 Benefits of recipe standardization

The benefits of standardization for food service management programmes are given below:

- **Customer satisfaction:** Recipe standardization ensures that the consumers get the same quality, presentation and portion size that they are accustomed to each time the meal is served.
- **Increased employee confidence:** Prevents cooks from preparing a substandard product. It helps training the employees in good food production and handling procedures.
- **Portion and yield control:** The amount of food that will be produced is the same every time with a standardized recipe. Hence, it will reduce leftover food and shortages.
- **Quality control:** Standardized recipes provide the same high-quality food every time they are used because they have been thoroughly tested and evaluated.
- **Consistent nutrient content:** The standardized recipe ensures the exact nutritional content of the food. This is very useful in hospital food service where the nutrient content of each recipe is to be considered.
- **Cost control:** It is easier to manage buying and storing food when using the same ingredients in the same quantities every time a particular recipe is made.
- **Reduce record keeping:** A record of the standardized recipes helps the food production team to refer the recipe when needed. Hence, even if there is a change of personnel it does not affect the quality or quantity of food.

2.2.2 Features of a standardized recipe

- It should be written in simple, understandable language.
- It should present the name of the recipe.
- It should include ingredients with quantities.
- Details of procedures, yield of recipe, portion size and cost of recipe.
- Equipment needed for the preparation of the recipe should be listed.

Standardization Procedures

Standardization involves the careful adjustment and readjustment of ingredients and their proportions to produce the most acceptable quality. There is a need for subjective as well as objective evaluation. Tests for achieving the best taste should be done for producing quality products.

Step 1: Preparation of original recipe

- The original recipe- Source of the recipe can be from cook books, magazines, family recipe files and commercial food companies.
- Recipe has to be prepared for a minimum serving of five portions.

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